

Exercise 1, Privacy and Data Protection

1. Valid Consent

example: google

Google collects account information, search activity, device information and so on. Some of this can be used to personalise services and advertisements. Google will ask for consent before using information for purposes that are not covered by its Privacy Policy.

According to Art. 6(1)(a) GDPR, processing is lawful if the data subject has given consent to the processing of personal data for one or more specific purposes. Consent is further defined in Art. 4(11) GDPR as being freely given, specific, informed and unambiguous, and it should result from a statement or clear affirmative action.

In my opinion, Google follows these requirements of GDPR. Users can change privacy settings, control personalised advertising and manage activities stored in their Google Account. The user has some control instead of consent being completely hidden inside the general terms of service.

2. Right to Access My Personal Data

According to GDPR Art. 15(1), a data subject has the right to ask a controller whether their personal data is being processed. If it is, the user can also request information including: the purposes of processing; the categories of personal data; recipients or categories of recipients; the expected storage period; rights to rectification, erasure or restriction; the right to complain to a supervisory authority; the source of the information when it was not collected directly from the user; and information about automated decision-making or profiling.

Art. 15(3) also requires the controller to provide a copy of the personal data being processed.

Google can provide data access request through its Privacy Help Center. the user can submit a request and specify the categories of relevant Google information.

I submitted a Data Access Request of Google on 04/10/2026, selected YouTube and requested the archive through my Google Account.

In practice, I think Google respects the right of access reasonably well because much of the process is automated. Users can directly inspect activity or generate an archive. This is useful for a service with a very large number of users.

3. Anonymisation and Pseudonymisation

Pseudonymisation means replacing identifying information with another identifier, while keeping the information needed to identify the person separately. pseudonymised data is still personal data under the GDPR. example: Alice→ user_84721

Anonymisation means removing or changing identifying information so that the person can no longer reasonably be identified. Properly anonymised data is no longer considered personal data under the GDPR.

The main difference is that pseudonymised data can still be re-identified, while anonymised data normally cannot.